

IN GOD'S NAME

The arrest of a high-profile godman opens a Pandora's box in Kerala as a number of spiritual heads and evangelists are arrested or charged with crimes ranging from rape to financial fraud

BOOPATHY



UNHOLY MEN

SANTHOSH MADHAVAN

Arrested, charged with cheating and sexual molestation of young girls

HIMAVAL MAHESWARANANDA BHADRANANDA

Arrested, charged with using a car fitted with unauthorised beacon lights

BISHOP K.P. YOHANNAN

Arrested, is being investigated for amassment of wealth

HEAVENLY FEAST EVANGELISTS GROUP

Income Tax Department investigation into wealth

MATHA PRASANNA

Arrested, facing charges of cheating and visa fraud

MA VISHNUMAYA

Husband arrested on complaint of cheating

SAM KUZHIKALA

Non-bailable warrant for issuing fake cheques

SIDDHAN KATTACHIRA

Arrested, faces charge of cheating

SWAMI SUNIL DAS

Investigation into his wealth

PITA JYOTHIRMAYANANDA

Arrested, non-bailable warrant for issuing fake cheques

SHEIKH YUSUF SULTAN

Facing charges of cheating

■ By M.G. Radhakrishnan

They are called godmen—or godwomen—but in Kerala at least, it seems that godliness is not exactly high on their agenda, quite the opposite. The arrest of Santhosh Madhavan alias Swami

Athmachaitanya of Kochi has opened the proverbial Pandora's box with a host of high-profile spiritual leaders on the run or under investigation for charges ranging from rape to molestation, fraud, hawala dealings and amassing wealth through fraudulent means. The involvement of

IN THE SPOTLIGHT:
Madhavan's arrest has led to a crackdown on his kind

Madhavan in a cheating case has put the spotlight on the swanky ashrams that dot the state, where, under the cover of offering spiritual